

Null Object Design Pattern

Lecture notes



Null Object: motivation

- If a method must return an object reference, but has nothing to return, it can return `null`
 - Therefore, calling methods must check for `null` before calling methods on the object
 - Or catch `NullPointerException`
- The test (or try...catch) would not be used most times
 - Inefficient, oft-repeated code
 - It would be good to avoid having to test or catch

Null Object: in practice

- Return an object that describes the behaviour (or lack thereof) when `null` would normally be returned
 - By returning an object, no longer need to test or catch

Activity



Coding

- Review the example code and watch out for:
 - how the project with patterns uses a `NullCommand` class to avoid testing for `null`
- If you have any questions, ask

Project: `LectureExample_WithPatterns`